

Part 3: Site Critique — thinktac.com

Susesh SJ — Engineer (Platform) Take-Home Assignment

Performance / Technical Concerns

The homepage loads several video widgets for different product categories (CBSE Science, CBSE Maths, Science Lab, NCERT Science, NCERT Maths, ICSE Science). On inspection, all of these point to the exact same underlying video file. The browser still issues a separate network request for each instance rather than reusing a cached copy in every case, since each sits in its own player element. On a slower connection this adds unnecessary data transfer and delays time-to-interactive, for content that is visually identical six times over. The page also leans heavily on autoplaying video near the top of the page, which competes with image and script loading for bandwidth during the initial page load.

User Experience / Product Gaps

The repeated identical video across categories is also a UX issue, not just a performance one: a visitor comparing "CBSE Science" against "ICSE Science" sees the same footage for both, which undercuts the purpose of showing a preview at all and may cause a visitor to assume the products are less differentiated than they actually are. Separately, primary navigation and calls-to-action are not always visually distinct from surrounding content, which can slow down a first-time visitor trying to figure out where to go to actually evaluate or purchase a product.

One Concrete Suggestion

Replace the autoplaying, duplicated video embeds with a single static poster image per category (a representative screenshot of that specific product), and load the actual video only when a visitor clicks that poster. Concretely: swap each `<video autoplay>` element for an `<img>` thumbnail with a play-button overlay, and attach a click handler that then injects the real `<video>` element (or a lazy-loaded `iframe`) with the category-specific clip, only at that point requesting the network resource. This removes five of the six duplicate video requests from the initial page load, gives each category a visually distinct preview, and makes the click-to-play interaction communicate to the visitor that they are about to see something specific to what they clicked, rather than a looping background clip.